

The Moonkeeper of Davao

In the quiet hills above Davao City, where the air smelled of mango blossoms and the stars blinked like secrets, lived a boy named Elian. He wasn't like the other kids in town—he had a peculiar job. Every night, while the world slept, Elian climbed the tallest hill with a lantern in one hand and a notebook in the other. His task? To keep the moon company.

Not many knew this, but the moon was terribly lonely. It had watched over Earth for eons, glowing quietly while people made wishes on it, wrote poems about it, and blamed it for their sleepless nights. But no one ever asked how the moon felt.

Elian did.

He'd sit on a rock, scribbling notes about the moon's mood. Some nights it was shy, hiding behind clouds. Other nights it was bold and full, casting silver light over the banana trees and rooftops. Elian would whisper stories to it—tales of jeepney rides, durian feasts, and the time he tried to build a bamboo raft that sank in five seconds.

The moon listened. And slowly, it began to change.

One night, the moon dipped lower than usual, casting a beam of light directly onto Elian's notebook. The boy gasped. The pages shimmered, and words rearranged themselves into glowing symbols. It was a message.

“Thank you for seeing me.”

From that night on, the moon glowed a little warmer over Davao. Crops grew richer, fishermen found their way home more easily, and people began to dream more vividly. They didn't know why—but Elian did.

He never told anyone. He just kept climbing the hill, lantern in hand, notebook ready, whispering stories to the sky.